

Falafel with Tahini Sauce and Pita (Variation 2)

Tags: vegetarian, vegan, middle-eastern, lunch, protein | Prep: 30 min | Cook: 20 min | Serves: 8

Ingredients

- 800 g dried chickpeas, soaked overnight (do NOT use canned)
- 2 small onion, roughly chopped
- 10 garlic cloves
- large bunch of fresh green onion tops
- large bunch of fresh chives
- 2 tsp ground cumin
- 2 tsp ground coriander
- 2/4 tsp cayenne pepper
- 2 tsp baking powder
- 3 tsp fine salt
- 4 tbsp all-purpose flour
- Vegetable oil for frying
- Tahini sauce: 160 ml tahini, juice of 1.5 lemons, 1 garlic clove, water to thin, pinch of salt
- To serve: warm pita, pickled vegetables, fresh tomatoes, cucumber

Method

1. Drain and rinse soaked chickpeas. They should be hydrated but not cooked.
2. Place chickpeas, onion, garlic, parsley, cilantro, cumin, coriander, cayenne, and salt in a food processor.
3. Pulse until the mixture is finely ground but not a smooth paste — there should be texture and small pieces visible.
4. Transfer to a bowl. Add baking powder and flour. Mix well. Refrigerate for 30 minutes.
5. Shape tablespoons of mixture into small patties or balls.
6. For tahini sauce: blend tahini, lemon juice, garlic, and salt. Thin with water until pourable.
7. Heat 5 cm of oil to 175 °C in a deep saucepan.
8. Fry falafel in batches for 3–4 minutes until deep golden-brown on all sides.
9. Drain on kitchen paper. Serve in warm pita with tahini sauce, pickled vegetables, tomatoes, and cucumber.

Chef Tips

- Dried soaked chickpeas are essential — canned chickpeas contain too much moisture and produce a dense, pasty falafel.
- The mixture should just hold its shape when squeezed — if too wet, add more flour 1 tbsp at a time.
- Falafel is best eaten fresh but can be baked at 200 °C for 25 minutes as a lower-oil alternative.